Week 3 Assignment: Jargon-to-Plain-English Clinic

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Passage 1: Rewrite

Our top priority is to fix the client's login bug before Friday. The bug is stalling three other tasks, so we need to sort it out right away. As the client is unhappy, we must commit our team's full capacity this week. We have already tried two quick fixes and neither worked. Tomorrow morning, the whole team will hold a short meeting and agree on the next steps. This should be a simple fix, but new problems keep appearing. Once we find the root cause, we plan to investigate the server logs together. Then we will follow up with the client and get started straight away on the next update. Please respond to me with your progress by 5 p.m. today. If we stay in agreement and act fast, we can close this ticket by tomorrow.

Before long, we plan to fix two more small bugs in the same module. The second looks like an easy job, so it should not take long. We still do not know why the server keeps crashing every night. The new intern offered to take charge of this bug while the senior developer is on leave. Tomorrow morning, another engineer will access the system to check the crash logs. We hope these small fixes will bring down the number of daily crashes. The client has asked for concrete advice on why this keeps happening. Our aim is to improve the entire server environment, not just patch one small part. This extra work is also a bonus for the client, since it may prevent future problems. We should finish it on schedule and keep everyone informed.

Late last night, the team finally found the real cause of the crash. We are now writing a permanent fix instead of another quick patch. We typically test every fix twice before sending it to the client. As this bug affected several clients, we will test even more carefully this time. We will trial the new server for one full day before calling it stable. After that, the team will move on with deployment to all remaining clients. This fix covers all of our core deliverables for this sprint, not just the login page. Our manager called it a complete solution and a major step forward for the support team. The new system is able to grow with demand and sits on a more solid framework than the old one. This fix should raise our whole product to a higher standard, and the team is ready to start the next project at once.

Passage 1: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at this point in time / at this juncture	now	wordy phrase
creating a bottleneck for	stalling	cliché
look after this issue	sort out	wrong phrasal verb ("look after" means care for)
due to the fact that / on account of the fact that	as	wordy phrase
leverage our full team bandwidth	commit our team's full capacity	jargon
it is important to note that / it should be noted that	(deleted)	filler
touch base and get on the same page	hold a short meeting and agree	cliché
for all intents and purposes	(deleted)	filler
deep dive into	investigate	jargon
circle back with	follow up with	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
hit the ground running	get started straight away	cliché
revert back to me	respond to me	misused ("revert" means return to a previous state) and redundant
in the near future	before long	wordy phrase
low-hanging fruit	easy job	cliché
take after this bug	take charge of	wrong phrasal verb ("take after" means resemble)
enter into the system	access the system	wrong phrasal verb
move the needle	bring down	cliché
with reference to the above	(deleted)	filler
actionable insights	concrete advice	jargon
optimize the whole server ecosystem	improve the entire server environment	jargon
value-add	bonus	jargon
in a timely manner	on schedule	wordy phrase
in the process of writing	now writing	wordy phrase
as a general rule	typically	wordy phrase
put up with	trial	wrong phrasal verb ("put up with" means tolerate)
continue on with	move on with	redundant
end-to-end solution	complete solution	jargon
game-changer	major step forward	cliché
scalable / robust	able to grow with demand / solid	jargon
take to the next-level	raise	cliché

Passage 2: Rewrite

Our team held its yearly planning meeting to discuss this year's plan. Our main goal is to collaborate better with the marketing department. As the last product launch was slow, we must do better this time. We agreed on five new action items and shared them with all key people involved. On hiring, we should ask the HR team before posting any new job. Everyone agreed to come up with fresh ideas and try a few new marketing ideas this quarter. However, we should not put everything into one idea by spending our entire budget on it. Next, the design team will analyse customer feedback and review our key skills. We should reduce our travel costs so we can spend more on this project. If everyone keeps coming up with fresh ideas and stops putting everything into one idea, this plan can succeed.

Later, the whole team met again to review our new marketing roadmap. At that moment, everyone agreed that we needed a growth-oriented mindset. Our manager called this a small change in approach for the whole marketing team. Let's go over the budget numbers together before we plan the next campaign. From now on, we also want more backing from the sales department. A team from different departments will work faster than one department alone. We should increase our social media budget a little to support this plan. Everyone agreed on one clear main target for this quarter: more repeat customers. The whole team is trying to come up with fresh ideas while planning these new campaigns.

When it comes to sales, the new plan already looks promising after just two weeks. We have found one easy win already: a simple change to our email subject lines. Overall, what we offer customers needed to be clearer than before. As our old website was slow, we lost several new customers last month. The design team studied a few good practices from other companies in our field. Sadly, two members left the project team this month. Mostly, the client understood why we had to postpone the product launch by two weeks. Our head of marketing now wants more authoritative content on our blog and social pages. Talking to real customers helped us understand their problems and enter new cities. This project taught us again not to put everything into one idea.

Passage 2: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at the present moment in time / at that particular point in time	now / at that moment	wordy phrase
annual alignment meeting	yearly planning meeting	vague jargon
needless to say / it goes without saying	(deleted)	filler
synergize better with	collaborate better with	jargon
in light of the fact that / by virtue of the fact that	as	wordy phrase
take it to the next level	do better	cliché
key stakeholders	all key people involved	jargon
with regard to the matter of	on	wordy phrase
look up to the HR team	ask the HR team	wrong phrasal verb ("look up to" means admire)
think outside the box	come up with fresh ideas	cliché
put all our eggs in one basket	put everything into one idea	cliché
drill down into	analyse	jargon
core competencies	key skills	jargon
lower down / raise up	reduce / increase	redundant

Original	Plain English	Why
in due course	later	wordy phrase
growth mindset	growth-oriented mindset	jargon
paradigm shift	small change in approach	jargon
get over the budget numbers	go over the budget numbers	wrong phrasal verb ("get over" means recover from)
on a going-forward basis	from now on	wordy phrase
buy-in	backing	jargon
cross-functional team	team from different departments	jargon
north star	main target	cliché
as far as sales are concerned	when it comes to sales	wordy phrase
quick win	easy win	jargon
in the final analysis / for the most part	overall / mostly	wordy phrase
value proposition	what we offer customers	jargon
best practices	good practices	jargon
exit out of	leave	redundant
call on the product launch	postpone the product launch	wrong phrasal verb ("call on" means visit or ask)
thought leadership content	authoritative content	jargon
pain points	problems	jargon
grow our footprint	enter new cities	cliché

Passage 3: Rewrite

Your report shows good effort, but a few sections still need work. If you have time before Friday, please add more practical suggestions for the sales team. For clarity, please explain your data in greater detail in section three. As noted, the client wants us to simplify the entire onboarding process. Please recheck these figures, since two of the numbers do not match the original file. We also expect added value in your final recommendations, not just a summary of the data. Try to take a broader view and think about every point of customer contact, not just the sales numbers. Our team regularly reviews these reports together before sending them to the client. Please send the corrected file back to me by Monday morning. The next move is yours now, and this report reflects your own hard work. Let's discuss it again tomorrow.

Please send the revised report as soon as possible, ideally before Wednesday. To make certain the numbers are correct, please check them one more time. Could you proofread the introduction once more before you send it back to me? For the third section, try to compare our results against a clear comparison point. As this report will go to senior management, please keep the key takeaways short and clear. An evidence-based approach in section two will also make your argument stronger. Try to make your final chart look more professional and first-rate. Please merge the two small tables into one, since they show similar numbers. Make your suggestions more practical, so the team knows exactly what to do next. A few small changes will polish your report and make it much stronger.

Your revised report is much clearer than the first draft. In most cases, small changes like these make a big difference to the reader. Please review the conclusion again and check the last two sentences carefully. Your new chart is far more effective than the old one. Your writing also feels more customer-focused now, since you explain things from the client's point of view. Overall, this report shows that you can respond quickly to feedback. Please add up all the final numbers before you send this to the client. Your recommendations are now more focused on value and outcomes than before. This report also shows a clearer strategic direction for the whole project. The next move is yours one last time, so please send the final file by tomorrow.

Passage 3: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at the end of the day	(deleted)	cliché filler
in the event that	if	wordy phrase
actionable feedback / actionable	practical suggestions / practical	jargon
for the purpose of clarity	for clarity	wordy phrase
more granular level	greater detail	jargon
as previously mentioned above	as noted	redundant
streamline	simplify	jargon
check up these figures	recheck these figures	wrong phrasal verb ("check up" needs "on")
value addition	added value	jargon
holistic approach	broader view	jargon
customer touchpoints	every point of customer contact	jargon
on a regular basis	regularly	wordy phrase
return back	send back	redundant
the ball is in your court	the next move is yours	cliché

Original	Plain English	Why
at your earliest convenience	as soon as possible	wordy phrase
in order to ensure	to make certain	wordy phrase
go off the introduction	proofread the introduction	wrong phrasal verb ("go off" means explode or leave)
with respect to	for	wordy phrase
owing to the fact that	as	wordy phrase
benchmark	clear comparison point	jargon
data-driven approach	evidence-based approach	jargon
best-in-class	first-rate	jargon
combine together	merge	redundant
as things currently stand	(deleted)	wordy phrase
in the majority of cases	in most cases	wordy phrase
look for the conclusion	review the conclusion again	wrong phrasal verb ("look for" means search for)
it is worth mentioning that	(deleted)	filler
impactful	far more effective	vague jargon
user-centric	customer-focused	jargon
on the whole	overall	wordy phrase
iterate	respond	jargon
add up together	add up	redundant
value-driven and results-oriented	focused on value and outcomes	jargon

Passage 4: Rewrite

India's AI conversation has mainly focused on large enterprises and major cloud providers running large language models (LLMs) on cloud-based infrastructure. But a far bigger opportunity lies in the country's over 60 million small and medium businesses (SMBs). Together, these firms contribute almost a third of India's GDP and form the backbone of the economy. Despite this scale, AI adoption among SMBs remains limited, held back by patchy IT infrastructure, little ability to connect systems through APIs (software links between programs), and the view that advanced AI is only for organisations with deep pockets and dedicated data science teams.

Tata Communications and Tata Tele-Business Services (TTBS) now intend to close this gap. Rather than launching another stand-alone application, the two companies are presenting their partnership as a single platform that many businesses share. Built on expandable cloud computing and edge connectivity (computing placed near users), it aims to make enterprise-grade AI infrastructure more affordable and accessible to smaller businesses so they can grow efficiently.

For many SMBs, the challenge has never been recognising AI's potential. It has been managing deployment, since businesses often have to deal with several vendors for connectivity, cloud infrastructure, data-sovereignty compliance and customer engagement tools. Integration costs, slow response times and the need for specialised technical skills often outweigh the perceived benefits, slowing adoption.

The first visible result of the partnership is an AI-powered Voice Agent platform, hosted on a dedicated AI cloud and powered by the companies' own conversational AI engine. It lets businesses deploy agents that understand natural language and can answer enquiries, schedule appointments and process orders easily. Unlike older interactive voice response (IVR) systems, these agents convert speech to text and back again to talk naturally with customers, and they are available 24 hours a day with no human involvement.

Finally, executives call the partnership a rare, major breakthrough, arguing that access to robust network infrastructure and very fast computing may soon matter as much as access to the AI models themselves. Whether this vision comes true will depend on execution, affordability, and how quickly SMBs feel comfortable trusting new digital technology.

Passage 4: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
for the most part	mainly	wordy phrase
hyperscalers	major cloud providers	jargon
cloud-native infrastructure	cloud-based infrastructure	jargon
bigger and greater / more than over	far bigger / over	redundant
lie / contributes / comprises	lies / contribute / form	grammar and word choice ("comprises" is misused here)
fragmented IT infrastructure	patchy IT infrastructure	jargon
API integration capabilities	ability to connect systems through APIs (software links between programs)	jargon, explained
looking forward to close	intend to close	wrong phrasal verb and grammar
multi-tenant	a single platform that many businesses share	technical jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
scalable, edge connectivity	expandable cloud computing and edge connectivity (computing placed near users)	jargon
to grow and to scale efficiently and effectively	grow efficiently	redundant
conundrum	challenge	unnecessary formal word
recognising and identifying	recognising	redundant
deployment orchestration	managing deployment	jargon
traverse multiple different vendors	deal with several vendors	wordy
connectivity provisioning	connectivity	jargon
latency issues	slow response times	jargon
really specialised / almost frequently	specialised / often	redundant, wrong adverb
outcome and result	result	redundant
proprietary conversational AI engine	the companies' own conversational AI engine	jargon
capable of and able to handle	can answer	redundant
with relative ease and without much difficulty	easily	redundant
leverage speech-to-text and text-to-speech pipelines and processes	convert speech to text and back again	jargon, redundant
around the clock, 24 hours a day / without human intervention whatsoever	24 hours a day / with no human involvement	redundant
in the end	finally	wordy phrase
game-changer that happens once in a blue moon	rare, major breakthrough	mixed clichés
low-latency compute / model architectures	very fast computing / AI models	jargon
materialises off	comes true	wrong phrasal verb
putting their trust up into	trusting	wrong phrasal verb
digital transformation technology	new digital technology	jargon

Passage 5: Rewrite

A Chinese startup called Linkerbot is working on a solution to one of robotics' biggest challenges: dexterous robotic hands with many independently moving joints. Founded in 2023 by CEO Alex Zhou, the Beijing-based company builds five-fingered robotic hands with touch sensors and motors that let humanoid robots grasp objects, tighten screws and, eventually, do household chores such as cooking and cleaning.

Copying the human hand, with its fine motor control, adaptable grip strength and sensory feedback, is an extremely hard job, industry insiders say. Even Tesla's Optimus struggles with hand dexterity, though its legs work just fine. Zhou believes that combining artificial intelligence with China's manufacturing strength will finally close this technology gap.

Linkerbot has raised a huge amount of funding, closing a Series B+ round in April that valued it at $3 billion, an enormous sum for such a young company. Zhou is now aiming for a $6 billion valuation, which would make him a billionaire almost overnight, and investors are lining up to take part.

The company's competitive advantage is low cost, since Linkerbot makes almost all of its components in-house. From motor assembly to sensor calibration, it can undercut rivals such as Singapore's Sharpa and London's Shadow Robot by a wide margin. Zhou insists that economies of scale will bring the hardware cost down to under $100 per pair within three years, a price that would badly undercut rivals.

Analysts warn, however, that the robotic-hands sector could fall into a race to the bottom, which China calls "involution", as competitors cut prices to survive. Some fear the industry could take on too much, mass-producing hands faster than the underlying AI and motor technology can keep up. Whether Linkerbot can stay afloat while scaling to 100,000 units a year and improving the number of independent joint movements its hands manage remains to be seen.

Passage 5: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
are cooking up a solution	is working on a solution	cliché and grammar
biggest headaches	biggest challenges	cliché
multi-degree-of-freedom	with many independently moving joints	jargon
actuator motors	motors	jargon
reverse-engineering	copying	jargon
herculean task	extremely hard job	cliché
reckons	believes	informal
manufacturing muscle	manufacturing strength	cliché
once and for all	finally	cliché
massive amounts of capital	a huge amount of funding	jargon
eye-watering sum	enormous sum	cliché
overnight, so to speak	almost overnight	filler
lining out to put in on the action	lining up to take part	wrong phrasal verbs
competitive hedge, redundantly speaking	competitive advantage	wrong word ("hedge" means protection) and filler
nearly almost all	almost all	redundant
vertically integrates ... in-house	makes ... in-house	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
bring downwards ... down	bring down	redundant
bill of materials	hardware cost	jargon
benchmark / undercut off	price / undercut	jargon, wrong phrasal verb
race to the bottom	kept and explained	idiom, clarified
stay put in the game	survive	wrong phrasal verb and cliché
biting off more than it can swallow	take on too much	garbled idiom
keep on up with	keep up	wrong phrasal verb
keep its head above the water	stay afloat	garbled idiom
degrees-of-freedom benchmarks	number of independent joint movements	jargon
remains to be saw	remains to be seen	grammar